

Phase 3 - UI/UX Development and Customization

Project: Leave Management System (ServiceNow Scoped Application)

Scope: x_1958846_leave_0

1. Objective

The native platform form used throughout Phase 2 was purpose-built for backend development and testing it is not the interface a real employee should ever have to use. Phase 3 delivered the actual **Service Portal experience**: the layer most employees and managers interact with day to day, built strictly as a presentation layer on top of the Phase 2 engine, never duplicating its validation logic.

The guiding principle for this phase was that **the portal should feel effortless precisely because all the hard logic already lives in Phase 2** the widgets built here call into the same Business Rules and the same Flow Designer approval mechanism already proven to work, rather than reinventing validation on the front end.

2. Components Delivered

2.1 Service Portal — Leave Request Form

A dedicated Service Portal widget allowing employees to submit a new leave request without ever touching the native platform UI. It mirrors the live Duration/Balance preview behavior already built as Client Scripts in Phase 2, so the portal experience feels identical to — and just as responsive as — the platform form, while being visually simplified for a non-technical audience.

Key behaviors carried over intentionally from the platform form, to avoid any inconsistency between the two surfaces:

- Half Day toggling hides/mirrors End Date exactly as it does on the platform form.
- Duration previews live as dates are selected.

- Submission still passes through the full Business Rule chain (BR1–BR4) server-side — the portal widget never bypasses or duplicates that validation, it simply presents the resulting success or error state cleanly.

2.2 Confirmation / Status Page

Immediately after submission, the employee sees a confirmation screen showing the generated Leave Request Number and a color-coded status badge (Open / Approved / Rejected), giving instant, unambiguous feedback that the request was received and is now in the approval pipeline.

2.3 Employee Dashboard

A widget summarizing, at a glance:

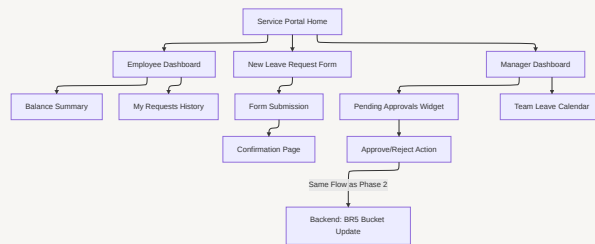
- Current balance per Leave Type, displayed with a simple visual indicator so an employee doesn't have to open a record to know how many days they have left
- A list of their own pending requests and recent history
- Quick access to submit a new request directly from the dashboard

2.4 Manager Dashboard

The manager-facing counterpart, focused entirely on reducing approval friction:

- A list of pending approvals assigned to the logged-in manager, sourced directly from the same native Approval records created by the Flow Designer flow in Phase 2 — no separate data source to keep in sync
- One-click Approve/Reject actions that call into the identical underlying approval mechanism already validated in Phase 2, ensuring a manager approving from the dashboard produces the exact same downstream effect (Business Rule 500 firing, Leave Bucket updating) as approving from the native Approvals list
- A simple team leave calendar view showing who on the manager's team is currently on approved leave

3. Information Architecture



4. UX Principles Applied

Principle	Application
Progressive disclosure	End Date is hidden entirely when Half Day is selected, removing a field the user would otherwise have to ignore
Immediate feedback	Live duration and balance preview before submission, rather than only finding out after clicking Submit
Error prevention over error correction	Client-side date validation catches obvious mistakes (End Date before Start Date) before the request ever reaches the server-side Business Rules
Status transparency	A consistent, color-coded status indicator is used identically across the confirmation page, employee dashboard, and manager dashboard
Role-appropriate views	Employees see only their own data; managers see a team-level approval queue — neither view exposes data the role shouldn't see, reinforced later by the ACLs built in Phase 4

5. Technical Approach

- Built as **Service Portal Widgets** (HTML/CSS/Client Controller/Server Script) rather than Catalog Items, since this is a direct table-backed form and dashboard experience, not a fulfillment-based service catalog request.
- The widgets treat the Phase 2 Business Rules as the single source of truth — server scripts inside each widget call `GlideRecord` / `GlideAjax` against the same `Leave Request`, `Leave Bucket`, and Approval tables, with **no duplicated validation logic** written into the portal layer. If a validation rule ever needs to change, it changes once, in one Business Rule, and both the platform form and the portal instantly reflect the update.
- The Manager Dashboard's Approve/Reject actions call directly into the same Flow-driven approval mechanism from Phase 2, rather than a

separate code path — this was a deliberate architectural choice to prevent the two approval entry points (native Approvals list vs. portal dashboard) from ever drifting into inconsistent behavior.

6. Deliverables Checklist

- ☒ ~~Service Portal page: Leave Request Form~~
- ☒ ~~Service Portal page: Confirmation/Status~~
- ☒ ~~Employee Dashboard widget~~
- ☒ ~~Manager Dashboard widget (approvals + team calendar)~~
- ☒ ~~Responsive/mobile layout verified (Now Mobile compatibility)~~
- ☒ ~~Visual design pass completed (branding, status color coding)~~